

TriAliasTB

User Guide - v1.0.4

Sort Thunderbird email aliases alphabetically without changing the order of mail accounts.

Documented version

This guide describes the public TriAliasTB v1.0.4 release. The interface in this version is French. The planned v1.1 release is intended to add interface internationalization.

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1. What TriAliasTB does

TriAliasTB is a Windows utility designed for Thunderbird users who want their aliases kept in alphabetical order. The program works with additional identities attached to a mail account without changing the order of mail accounts.

- Thunderbird profiles are detected automatically from profiles.ini.
- The primary identity is always kept first.
- Only aliases are sorted, using their email addresses.
- A backup of prefs.js is created before any write operation.
- Thunderbird must be closed before changes are made.
- The standalone EXE can run without Python installed on the PC.

2. Before you start

Required condition

To perform the actual sort, Thunderbird must be closed. TriAliasTB detects its state automatically and enables or disables the sort button accordingly.

- Download TriAliasTB.exe from the official GitHub v1.0.4 release.
- Python does not need to be installed.
- For the first use, it is recommended to keep Thunderbird closed while starting TriAliasTB.

3. Downloading and launching TriAliasTB

The distributed Windows program is provided as an executable named TriAliasTB.exe. You may place it in any folder you prefer.

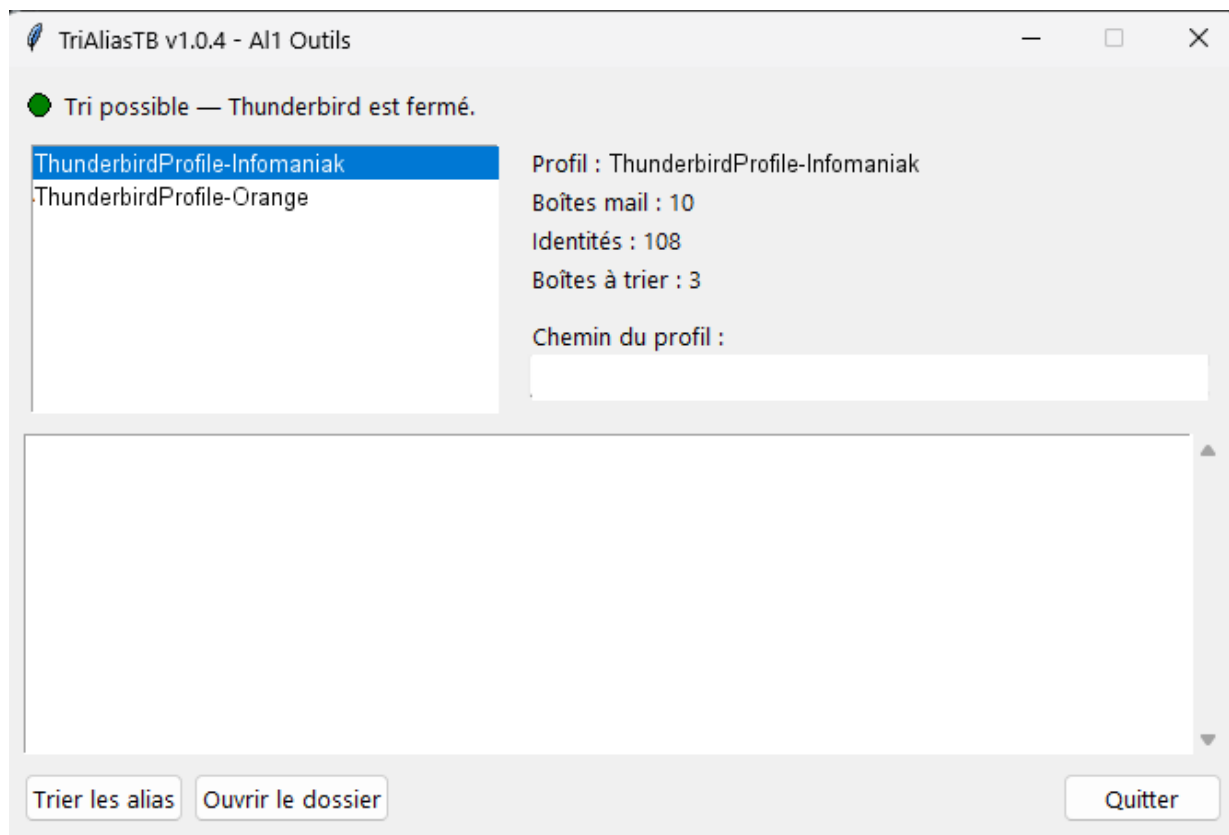
Windows SmartScreen warning

When downloading and launching the program for the first time, Microsoft Defender SmartScreen may display a warning stating that the application is “unrecognized”. This can happen because the application is new and has not yet built a reputation with Microsoft. To launch TriAliasTB, click More info, then Run anyway.

This warning concerns the file's reputation with SmartScreen; by itself it is not a malware diagnosis. Windows security behavior can vary by Windows version and download context.

4. First use and profile selection

At startup, TriAliasTB automatically searches for available Thunderbird profiles. The profile list is displayed on the left side of the window. Select the profile you want to inspect.

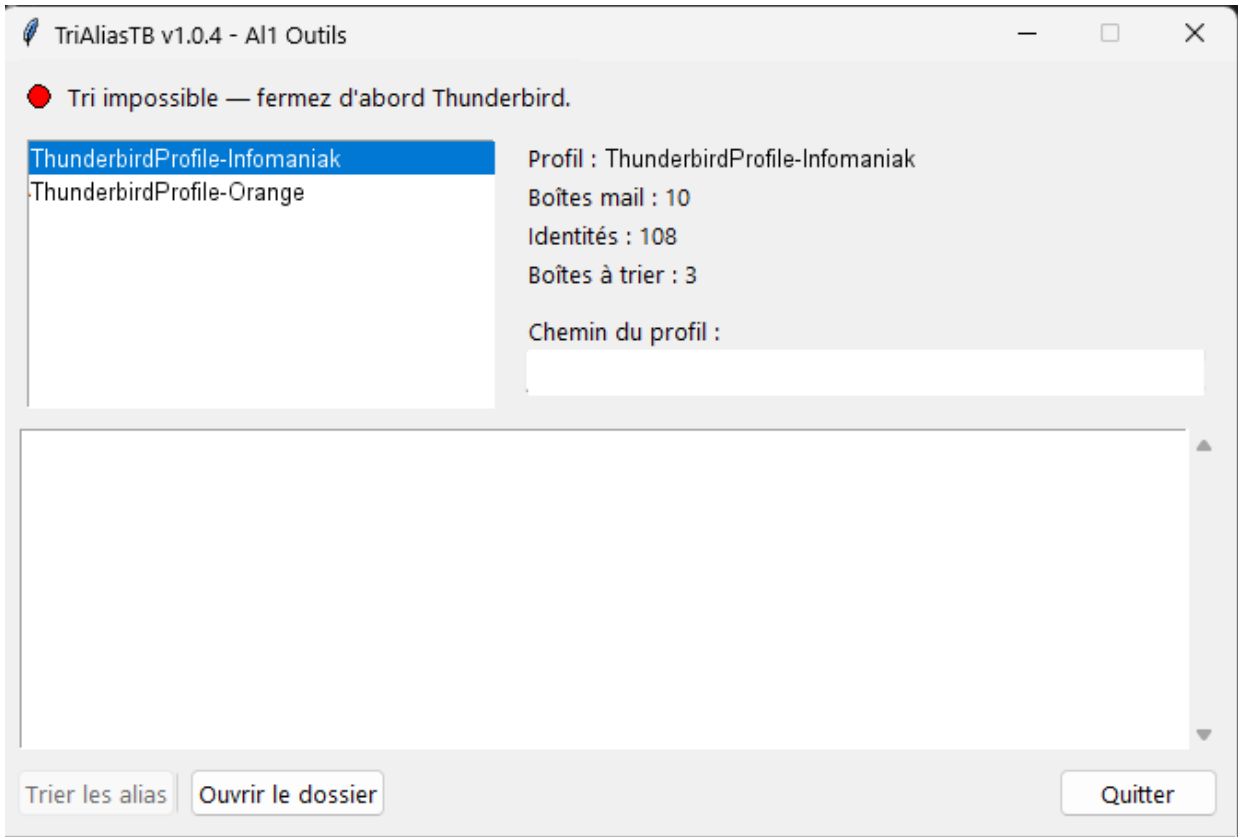


Example: Thunderbird is closed, a profile is selected and sorting is available.

The information area shows the profile name, the number of mail accounts, the total number of identities and the number of accounts that require sorting.

5. Checking the Thunderbird status

The indicator and status message at the top of the window show whether sorting is currently possible. The state is refreshed automatically, so you do not have to restart TriAliasTB after closing Thunderbird.



Thunderbird is running: the indicator is red and the “Trier les alias” button is disabled.

Red indicator	Sorting is blocked - close Thunderbird first.
Green indicator	Sorting is available - Thunderbird is closed.

6. Sorting aliases

When the indicator is green and the Trier les alias button is active:

- Click Trier les alias.
- Confirm the operation when TriAliasTB asks for confirmation.
- The program first creates a backup of prefs.js.
- Only the account identity lines are rewritten with the aliases sorted.
- The profile is analyzed again automatically after sorting.

The first identity in the identity list remains at the front: it is the primary identity. Additional identities are ordered alphabetically by email address, while the order of Thunderbird mail accounts is left unchanged.

7. When there is nothing to sort

No unnecessary changes

When all mail accounts are already in the expected order, TriAliasTB displays Rien à trier. Tous les alias sont déjà dans l'ordre. No additional prefs.js backup is created and no change is made.

8. Safety, backup and portable operation

- A backup of prefs.js is created before each write operation, with a name such as prefs.js.bak_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.
- Only mail.account.accountX.identities= lines are rewritten.
- TriAliasTB does not change the order of mail accounts.
- The application does not write to the Windows Registry or to %APPDATA% or %LOCALAPPDATA%.
- First-run settings can be stored in TriAliasTB.ini in the program folder.

9. Quick troubleshooting

The sort button is disabled.	Make sure Thunderbird is completely closed. The indicator should turn green automatically.
The expected profile is not listed.	Check that the profile is registered by Thunderbird in profiles.ini.
Windows shows a SmartScreen warning.	Open "More info", then use "Run anyway" when the EXE was downloaded from the official release.
You do not want to change anything.	Close TriAliasTB without starting the sort. Analysis alone does not modify the profile.

10. Where to find the program

GitHub: <https://github.com/alloutils/TriAliasTB>

Release v1.0.4: <https://github.com/alloutils/TriAliasTB/releases/tag/v1.0.4>

The repository contains the Python source, build files, documentation and license files. The EXE is also provided as a Release asset.

Note for users

Version v1.0.4 is the public French-language edition. Interface internationalization is planned for v1.1.

Document prepared for TriAliasTB v1.0.4 distribution - All Outils